BrainByte Arena

Rules, point system, qualification and final selection
For the event host. Every number below is the default and can be changed in the admin dashboard (Rounds & scoring) before a round starts.

1. Event flow

Stage	What happens
Registration	Up to 20 teams of 2 players. Team names must be unique. Teams are auto-approved by default.
Level 1 - Tech Faces	Live. 10 "who is this?" picture questions, 20 s each, with a reveal.
Level 2 - Tech Bingo	Live. 16 clue calls, 15 s each. Every team has its own shuffled 4x4 card.
Level 3 - Quick Brain	Self-paced quiz. 12 questions, 10 minute round clock, Skip allowed.
Level 4 - Reel Rush	Live. 12 questions, 20 s each, with streaks and one Double Down per team.
Qualification	The host opens it. The top N teams (default 5) become finalists.
Level 5 - Final Showdown	Finalists only. 10 live questions, 25 s each. 3 lives, steals, last team standing.
Podium	The host finishes the event. The projector shows the podium and champion.

Scores are cumulative. A team's total is the sum of every point earned in every level, so Level 5 starts from the Level 1-4 total.

2. Points per round

Round	Base points	Speed bonus	Extra bonuses	Wrong or no answer
L1 Tech Faces	100 per question	0-50	Fastest correct +30 Streak: +20 x previous streak (max 3)	0 points. Streak resets.
L2 Tech Bingo	50 per correct tile	0-25	Each completed line +75 (4 rows, 4 columns, 2 diagonals) Blackout (full card) +250	0 points.
L3 Quick Brain	100 per question	0-10	None	0 points. A skip scores 0 with no penalty. Hints are off by default.
L4 Reel Rush	100 per question	0-100	Fastest correct +50 Streak: +25 x previous streak (max 4) Double Down (once per team)	0 points. Streak resets. Wrong Double Down costs the base points.
L5 Final Showdown	200 per question	0-150	Fastest correct +100 Steal 75 Survivor bonus +300	Lose one life.

3. How the bonuses work

- **Speed bonus.** It falls in a straight line from the maximum down to 0 across the question window. Answering instantly earns the maximum; answering at the buzzer earns 0.
- **Fastest finger.** The first correct answer received by the server gets the bonus. The server clock is the only clock.
- **Streak.** The bonus is the number of correct answers in a row before this one (capped) times the streak value. The first correct answer earns no streak bonus, the second earns one step, and so on. A wrong or missing answer resets the streak to 0.
- **Double Down (Level 4, once per team).** Correct: an extra amount equal to base points plus speed bonus, so the question is worth double. Wrong: the base points (100) are taken away.
- **Scoring time.** Answers are locked in silently. Nothing is scored or shown until the reveal. A question closes early once every team still playing has answered. Late answers score nothing.

4. Final Showdown rules

- Only finalists play. Everyone starts with **3 lives**.
- A wrong answer or no answer costs one life. A correct answer costs nothing.
- At 0 lives a team is **eliminated**. It keeps its points but cannot answer any more.
- **Steal:** the fastest correct team takes up to 75 points from the highest-scoring team among those that did not answer correctly on that question. The victim loses the same amount.
- **Sudden-death protection:** if every remaining team would reach 0 lives on the same question, nobody is eliminated and each keeps 1 life.
- The round ends early when one team is left. Every team still alive at the end collects the **300 survivor bonus**.

5. Qualification (after Level 4)

- The host opens qualification once Level 4 has ended.
- The **top N teams** by cumulative Level 1-4 total become finalists. N is 5 by default and can be set from 1 to 20 on the Event tab.
- A tie at the cutoff is broken by the tie-break order in section 7.
- The host can reopen qualification and change N until Level 5 starts. When Level 5 starts, the finalists are frozen.
- Teams that do not qualify stay on the leaderboard but cannot play Level 5.

6. Final selection: who wins

Order	Rule
1. Tier	Finalists still standing rank first. Finalists who lost all 3 lives come next. Non-finalists come last.
2. Total points	Highest cumulative total. Survivors' totals include the 300 bonus.
3. Tie-breakers	Applied only if tier and total are equal (section 7).

Last team standing outranks raw points. A finalist who is eliminated with 5000 points ranks **below** a survivor with 3000 points. Eliminated finalists are ordered among themselves by total points, and all of them still rank above teams that never qualified. Rank 1 is the champion and ranks 1-3 make the podium.

7. Tie-breakers (in order)

1. Higher total score.
2. Higher score in the most recently played level.
3. More challenges solved.
4. Earlier time of the last scored solve (reaching the score first wins).
5. Lowest team id. This only keeps the order stable; the row is flagged **tie** in every view so the host can decide by hand.

8. Host controls

- **Skip (void) question:** nobody scores and no life is lost.
- **Pause / Resume / End round:** pausing freezes the question timer.
- **Score corrections:** manual adjustments need a written reason and are recorded in the audit log.
- **Export CSV:** the leaderboard export matches the projector and phones.
- **Timing:** an answer counts if the server receives it by the deadline (inclusive). Two answers in the same millisecond are ordered by arrival.